WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	April 20-24, 2026 (Week 2, Account 3)
Report Generated:	April 24, 2026
Trader:	James
Account:	Account 3 — $500,000 paper
Strategies:	SPX Bull Put Spreads | SPX Bear Call Spreads | Long Puts | 1DTE Experimental
Market:	Iran ceasefire holding. S&P above 7,000. VIX 18-22. Mixed-to-bearish intraday.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: +$19,555 across 21 trades. Clean system: +$22,455 across 16 trades (81.3% win rate, 13 wins, 3 losses). The busiest week of Account 3 so far, with significant developments: the market weather indicator produced the week's best trade (#121, +$3,750, 83% capture), Tuesday exposed a critical low-conviction trading pattern, the OCO/cancel platform issues escalated to a cascade event costing -$2,250, and Friday's 1DTE experimental trades produced useful data on day-before-expiry premium dynamics.

Key Findings:

- Clean system continues to deliver: +$22,455 across 16 trades. 13 wins, 3 losses (2 long puts + 1 experimental).
- Market weather indicator validated: Trade #121 entered on BEARISH 4.5/5 signal after waiting out choppy conditions. 83% capture. Best trade of the week.
- Low conviction Tuesday: Trades 117-118 were profitable by luck. Journal notes they would have been stopped out if held. Pre-trade fitness check needs upgrading.
- OCO cascade on Tuesday: Cancel triggered entry, which triggered a second position. 10 failed close attempts. -$2,250 from platform fault. TOS order management now a material risk.
- 1DTE experiments (Friday): Three trades testing day-before-expiry dynamics. Mixed results — useful data but thesis needs refinement.
- Profitable every day: Mon +$6,980 | Tue +$2,750 | Wed +$5,500 | Thu +$4,050 | Fri +$275.

Strategic Assessment: The second full week of Account 3 shows a maturing system. The stand-out moment is trade 121 — patiently waiting through a choppy Tuesday for the market weather indicator to reach BEARISH 4.5/5, then entering with conviction for an 83% capture. That's the three-layer edge framework in action: empirical probability, regime awareness, and directional signal. Conversely, Tuesday's low-conviction entries (117-118) demonstrate what happens without the signal — small profits by luck, not by edge. The contrast between these two approaches is the week's clearest lesson.

WEEKLY P&L; SUMMARY

Strategy	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win %	Net P&L
SPX Bear Call Spreads (clean)	7	7	0	100%	+$16,125
SPX Bull Put Spreads (clean)	6	5	1	83.3%	+$7,100
Long Puts	2	0	2	0%	-$770
1DTE Experimental (Fri)	3	2	1	66.7%	+$1,675
Platform Errors	5	2	3	—	-$2,900
TOTAL	**21**	**16**	**5**	**76.2%**	**+$19,555**
TOTAL ex-errors	**16**	**13**	**3**	**81.3%**	**+$22,455**

CUMULATIVE ACCOUNT 3

Metric	Week 1 (Apr 13-17)	Week 2 (Apr 20-24)	Cumulative
Clean Trades	9	16	25

Metric	Week 1 (Apr 13-17)	Week 2 (Apr 20-24)	Cumulative
Clean Win Rate	100%	81.3%	88%
Clean P&L	+$29,250	+$22,455	+$51,705
Error P&L	+$2,000	-$2,900	-$900
Total P&L	+$31,250	+$19,555	+$50,805

Account 3 cumulative: +$50,805 in two weeks. Clean system at +$51,705 (25 trades, 88% win rate). Error P&L; is -$900 — effectively neutral, compared to the -$190,842 in errors across Accounts 1-2. The error profile has shifted from catastrophic trade decisions to platform mechanical issues.

DAILY TRADE BREAKDOWN

MONDAY 20 APR — +$6,980 (Strong Start)

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Capture	Notes
112	BCS	7160/7180	50	$1.20	$0.35	+$4,250	71%	Clean. 1 hour hold.
113	BCS	7155/7175	50	$1.10	$0.45	+$3,250	59%	Second BCS same session.
114	Long Put	7095P	1	$9.30	$9.50	-$20	—	Quick scratch.
115	Long Put	7090P	1	$7.50	$0.00	-$750	—	Expired worthless.
116	BCS Err	7155/7175	50	$0.10	$0.15	+$250	—	ERR: Forgotten cancel.

Bear call spreads dominated: +$7,500 from two clean BCS trades. The long puts (-$770 combined) were directional experiments that didn't work — small cost, useful learning. Forgotten cancel on #116 is the new workflow's teething issue with standalone orders replacing OCO.

TUESDAY 21 APR — +$2,750 (The Contrasting Day)

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Hold	Notes
117	BPS	7055/7035	50	$0.85	$0.75	+$500	5min	Low conviction. Lucky.
118	BPS	7050/7030	50	$0.80	$0.70	+$500	16min	Low conviction. Lucky.
119	BPS Err	7050/7030	50	$1.50	$1.55	+$250	1min	ERR: OCO cancel triggered.
120	BPS Err	7050/7030	50	$1.55	$2.00	-$2,250	10 tries	ERR: OCO cascade. Market order.
121	BCS	7110/7130	50	$0.90	$0.15	+$3,750	—	BEARISH 4.5/5. 83%. BEST.

Tuesday tells two stories. Trades 117-118 were entered without conviction — the journal notes they would have been stopped out if held. Profitable by luck, not edge. Then the OCO cascade (119-120) cost -$2,000 net from pure platform failure. Finally, trade 121: the market weather indicator reached BEARISH 4.5/5, you waited for confirmation, entered with conviction, and captured 83% of premium. The lesson is stark: low conviction trades + platform chaos = barely positive. High conviction with signal = +$3,750 in one trade.

WEDNESDAY 22 APR — +$5,500 (Clean Wednesday)

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Capture	Notes
122	BPS	7035/7015	50	$0.60	$0.05	+$2,750	92%	Near-full capture.
123	BPS	7080/7060	50	$0.90	$0.40	+$2,500	56%	Clean.
124	BPS Err	7080/7060	50	$0.05	$0.10	+$250	—	ERR: Forgotten cancel #2.

Trade 122 at 92% capture is near-perfect execution — sold at $0.60, closed at $0.05, almost full premium. The forgotten cancel (#124) is the second instance this week of the standalone order workflow's teething issue. Needs adding to the post-close checklist.

THURSDAY 23 APR — +$4,050

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Capture	Notes
125	BCS	7165/7180	100	$1.25	$1.20	+$500	4%	1-min scalp. 100 lots.
126	BPS	7105/7075	35	$1.15	$0.85	+$1,050	26%	30pt wide. 17 mins.
127	BCS	7130/7145	50	$1.00	$0.85	+$750	15%	Evening. 6 mins.
128	BCS	7180/7195	70	$1.20	$0.95	+$1,750	21%	Overnight into Friday.

Four wins but lower capture rates (4-26%). The 100-lot scalp (#125) at 4% shows the razor-thin margin on quick scalps — $500 profit on $12,500 credit with $137,500 max risk. Trade 128 overnight hold into Friday shows confidence holding positions when conviction is high.

FRIDAY 24 APR — +$275 (Experimental Day)

#	Type	Strikes	Cts	Entry	Exit	P&L	Notes	Status
129	BCS Err	7180/7195	70	$0.95	$0.75	-$1,400	Failed cancel.	ERR
130	BCS	7220/7235	25	$1.25	$1.15	+$250	1DTE expt. 8% capture.	
131	BCS	7215/7230	25	$1.25	$0.60	+$1,625	1DTE expt. 52%. 1hr 17m.	
132	BPS	7035/7015	10	$1.30	$1.50	-$200	1DTE expt. Loss.	

1DTE Experiment Results: Three trades testing selling the day before expiry and closing same day. Trade 130 barely moved (8% capture). Trade 131 worked well (52% in 77 minutes). Trade 132 lost. The thesis — higher premium from extra DTE but lower theta — needs refinement. Premium needs to be at least double normal 0DTE trades to offset the slower decay.

TRADE 121: MARKET WEATHER INDICATOR IN ACTION

Detail	Value
Position	SPX 7110/7130 Bear Call Spread, 50 contracts
Market Weather Signal	BEARISH 4.5/5
VIX at Entry	20.41 (+8.16% on the day)
Context	All instruments bearish. Choppy conditions earlier. Signal solidified late.
Entry	$0.90 credit
Exit	$0.15
Premium Capture	83.3%
P&L	+$3,750
Approach	Waited out choppy conditions. Entered only when signal reached high conviction.

This is the three-layer edge framework working in real-time: Layer 1 (empirical baseline) said a 2% move at VIX 20 is relatively unlikely. Layer 2 (options chain) was offering $0.90 on the BCS. Layer 3 (market weather indicator) signalled BEARISH 4.5/5, confirming the directional read. The key discipline: you waited. Despite the choppy morning, you didn't enter until the signal was clear. When it came, you acted with conviction. 83% capture. +$3,750. This is the model for every future trade.

LOW CONVICTION TRADING: THE TUESDAY CONTRAST

Trades 117 and 118 were entered during choppy conditions without a clear signal. The journal notes: 'Low conviction entries during an off day. Profitable by luck — would have been stopped out on all three if held. Pre-trade fitness check needs upgrade.'

	Low Conviction (117-118)	High Conviction (121)
Signal Strength	None / low	BEARISH 4.5/5
Hold Time	5-16 minutes (fled quickly)	Full position hold
Premium Capture	12-13%	83%
P&L	+$1,000 combined	+$3,750 single trade
Would It Survive?	No — journal says stopped out if held	Yes — full premium decay
Edge Present?	No — profitable by luck	Yes — directional signal confirmed

The Lesson: Two low-conviction trades made $1,000 by luck and required fleeing the position quickly. One high-conviction trade made $3,750 with discipline. The pre-trade fitness check should include: "Does the market weather indicator support this direction?" If the answer is no or unclear, don't trade. Wait for the signal. Tuesday proved that patience with one good trade beats impatience with three mediocre ones.

PLATFORM ERROR ESCALATION

#	Error Type	P&L	Detail
116	Forgotten cancel	+$250	Standalone order triggered unintended entry. Profitable by luck.
119	OCO cancel triggered entry	+$250	Cancel action opened position instead of cancelling.
120	OCO cascade	-$2,250	Closing #119 triggered SECOND unintended position. 10 failed close attempts. Market order exit.
124	Forgotten cancel	+$250	Second instance of standalone workflow teething.
129	Failed cancel	-$1,400	Cancel didn't reach TOS servers. Stop triggered unintended entry.

Total error cost: -$2,900. The OCO cascade (#119-120) is the most concerning: a cancel action opened a position, and closing that position opened another one, and 10 close attempts failed before a market order executed at a significant loss. This is not user error — it's a platform defect that can cascade into material losses.

The Workflow Evolution:

1. OCO brackets (Account 1-2): Caused ghost trades when one leg filled.
2. Standalone orders (Account 3 new): Cancel actions sometimes trigger entries instead.
3. Current state: Neither workflow is fully reliable on TOS mobile.

→ **Recommended:** Desktop TOS for all order management. Mobile for monitoring only. Add 'Verify position is flat' to post-close checklist. File TOS support ticket with documented evidence.

RISK FRAMEWORK ASSESSMENT

Rule	Tested?	Outcome
R1: 50% profit limit	Yes	Most trades closed 15-92%. Flexible capture working.
R7: Limit orders only	Yes	All entries via limits. Clean.
R13: New strategies 50% size	Yes	1DTE experiments at 10-25 contracts (reduced size). Following.
R18: Min credit 20% of width	Yes	All spreads above threshold.
R19: No 0DTE binary catalysts	Yes	No binary events this week. Ceasefire holding.
R20: Close 0DTE by 3:30pm	Yes	All 0DTE flattened before close.
NEW: Wait for weather signal	Partially	Followed on #121 (best trade). Ignored on #117-118 (low conviction).

Framework compliance remains strong. The one gap: trades 117-118 entered without a conviction signal. The market weather indicator should be a required check before entry, not an optional enhancement. When followed (#121), it produced the best trade of the week.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ Market weather indicator: Trade 121 entered on BEARISH 4.5/5. 83% capture. Waited for signal. Best trade of week.
- ✓ Bear call spreads: 100% clean win rate, +$16,125. The bearish side is working well in current conditions.
- ✓ Trade 122: 92% premium capture. Near-perfect execution.
- ✓ Daily profitability: All five days profitable. Consistency over home runs.
- ✓ 1DTE at reduced size: Experiments properly sized at 10-25 contracts per Rule 13.
- ✓ Long put sizing: $750 max on a directional experiment. Small cost, useful learning.

WHAT NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

- **1. No-Signal = No-Trade:** Trades 117-118 were entered without conviction and survived by luck. The market weather indicator should be a required gate, not optional. If there's no signal, wait.
- **2. TOS Order Management:** Five error trades this week from platform issues. The OCO cascade (#119-120) cost -$2,250. Move all order management to desktop. Add position verification to post-close checklist.
- **3. Quick Scalps Risk/Reward:** Trade 125 made $500 on $137,500 max risk (0.36% return). At 100 contracts for a 1-minute hold, the risk/reward on micro-scalps needs examination.
- **4. 1DTE Thesis Refinement:** Day-before-expiry trades need at least 2x normal 0DTE premium to justify the slower theta decay. Trade 130's 8% capture suggests the premium wasn't sufficient.

CONCLUSION

+$50,805 in Two Weeks. Account 3 is now firmly positive with +$51,705 in clean P&L; across 25 trades at an 88% win rate. The error deficit is just -$900 — a world away from the -$190,842 in errors across Accounts 1 and 2. The system is working. The discipline is holding.

The Week's Defining Moment: The contrast between Tuesday's low-conviction entries (+$1,000 by luck) and trade 121 (+$3,750 on a clear BEARISH 4.5/5 signal) is the clearest evidence yet that the market weather indicator adds genuine value. When you wait for the signal and act with conviction, the results are materially better than when you trade without it. The next step: make the signal a required pre-trade gate, not a nice-to-have.

The Platform Problem: TOS order management is now the single biggest operational risk. Five error trades, -$2,900 total, and a cascade event that required 10 close attempts. Desktop TOS for all order management. Mobile for monitoring only. This is urgent.

Next Report: Friday, May 1, 2026